

Alxasaurus

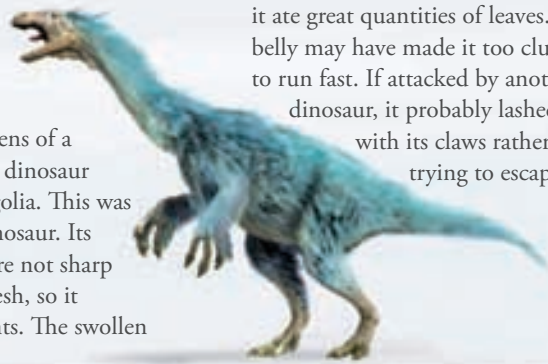
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- **When** 130 million years ago (Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** China
- **Habitat** Woodlands
- **Length** 13 ft (4 m)
- **Diet** Plants

In 1988, five specimens of a previously unknown dinosaur were found in Mongolia. This was *Alxasaurus*, a therizinosaur. Its leaf-shaped teeth were not sharp enough to tear off flesh, so it probably fed on plants. The swollen

stomach of *Alxasaurus* indicates that it ate great quantities of leaves. Its big belly may have made it too clumsy to run fast. If attacked by another dinosaur, it probably lashed out with its claws rather than trying to escape.



FAMILY FACT FILE

Key features

- Long necks
- Enormous curved claws on fingers
- Short tails
- Four-toed feet
- Partly feathered

When

Therizinosaurids first appeared in the Early Cretaceous, 130 million years ago. They died out in the Late Cretaceous, 65 million years ago.

Model based on a fossilized therizinosaur embryo found inside an egg.

